## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(a)** dreams are earned through sustained commitment and help from others | Central. |
| 2 | **(b)** safety may cost us growth | Interpretation. |
| 3 | **(b)** Having counted the cost, Ming began her journey. | Perfect participle. |
| 4 | **(a)** it assumes the dreamer has access to support and resources | Critique. |
| 5 | **(c)** a belief that courage is a choice | Ethos. |
| 6 | **(b)** Mother said that had she known my plan, she would have helped. | Unreal past retained. |
| 7 | **(b)** honest care | Honesty. |
| 8 | **(b)** Avoid all challenges | Contradicts. |
| 9 | **(d)** persistence | Persistence. |
| 10 | **(c)** dreams must be 'paid for' with effort | Metaphor. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | It includes cost, sacrifice and change (1) so it tempers idealism with reality (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Clear structure and tone (1) with honest, kind content (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Plain words reflect decisive action (1) and avoid excuses (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | She does not deny it (1) but frames effort and learning as valuable anyway (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Sacrifice shows commitment (1). Not all success needs the same sacrifice (1). The letter stresses it as a typical cost (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Simplicity reaches all (1). It matches direct action (1). It avoids obscuring the message (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Barely had she started when problems arose (1). Inversion after barely (1). It adds emphasis (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** It acknowledges cost (1). It accepts change (1). It stresses support (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Comfort as a room or trap (1). The challenge as a climb or door (1). Metaphors show the cost of staying (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** It means to work late into the night (1). Dreams may need such effort (1). It illustrates sacrifice (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Hope begins the dream (1). Effort fulfils it (1). Sacrifice is the price (1). Support is the safety net (1). Flexibility keeps the contract fair (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Letter: explanation and advice (1). Poem: image and rhythm (1). Letter is personal (1). Poem is universal (1). Both aim at action (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Warmth (1). Honesty (1). Practical advice (1). Respect for Ming's choice (1). Effect on the reader (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Greeting (1). Letter's lessons (1). Poem's lessons (1). Practical steps (1). Closing (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** failure gives experience that builds success | Learning. |
| 2 | **(b)** ambition | Ambition. |
| 3 | **(a)** she is excited but uncertain | Inference. |
| 4 | **(d)** limits growth though it feels safe | Distinction. |
| 5 | **(d)** Who would not want to follow a dream? | Rhetorical. |
| 6 | **(b)** encourages bold dreaming while insisting on realism | Balanced. |
| 7 | **(a)** security vs aspiration | Tension. |
| 8 | **(b)** a persistent learner who masters a skill by practice | Counterexample. |
| 9 | **(a)** to be free to follow a dream, one must bind oneself to discipline | Paradox. |
| 10 | **(b)** repetition of a call such as 'Take the step!' | Persuasion. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Passion starts the journey (1) and discipline sustains it (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | The letter speaks to one person with wider relevance (1). The poem speaks to everyone directly (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Love gives credibility and warmth (1) while personal stakes make it sincere (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | 'Step up' commands action (1) and implies we are capable (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | A letter is personal and sincere (1). It allows advice without pressure (1). It becomes a lasting guide (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | It praises courage (1). It may not detail dangers (1). It leaves room for the reader's judgement (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | For: practicality brings results (1). Against: bold dreams inspire (1). A mix works best, as the letter shows (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** The advice applies to anyone (1). The mother-daughter bond adds warmth (1). It empowers a girl to dream (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | If Ming had planned, she would not have struggled (1). Third conditional (1). Marks regret about the past (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Persistence keeps effort going (1). Flexibility adapts the aim (1). Together they prevent burnout (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Emotional greeting (1). Logical points on cost (1). Examples of support (1). Balanced caution (1). Hopeful end (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Format (1). Encouragement (1). Cost and effort (1). Support (1). Closing (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Introduction (1). Lack of action (1). Underestimating cost (1). Lack of support (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Opening (1). The goal (1). The fear (1). The step (1). Ending (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** dreams demand courage, effort, support and flexibility | Synthesis. |
| 2 | **(a)** evidence that effort rarely matters | Counter-evidence. |
| 3 | **(b)** valuing every goal | Inclusive view. |
| 4 | **(a)** courage and persistence | Common. |
| 5 | **(d)** growth over rigid plans | Adaptability. |
| 6 | **(b)** If Ming had planned better, she would have succeeded sooner. | Had + would have. |
| 7 | **(b)** an example of wishful thinking | Link. |
| 8 | **(d)** a dream should match one's passion and ability | Fit. |
| 9 | **(c)** Only by sustained effort can dreams come true. | Inversion after only. |
| 10 | **(d)** The First Step Is Yours | Title. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | It stresses individual effort (1) but also notes the role of support systems (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Access to support and resources matters (1) so the letter's advice works best with help, which it acknowledges (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Fear is natural (1) but must not decide our actions (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Offer guidance and opportunities (1) and encourage persistence and flexibility (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Honesty builds trust (1). It prepares Ming for reality (1). It respects her ability to cope (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Ming was given valuable advice by her mother (1). Indirect object becomes subject (1). Verb: was given (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Letter: fear as a reason to plan (1). Poem: fear as a barrier to cross (1). Both urge acting despite fear (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** She may underestimate effort (1). She may give up early (1). She may feel regret (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Having read the letter, Ming made a plan (1). Perfect participle shows earlier action (1). Same subject (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** A plan needs steps (1). A deadline adds urgency (1). The letter supports planning and effort (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Theme (1). Imperative voice (1). Metaphor (1). Rhythm (1). Effect (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Meaning (1). The poem's first step (1). The letter's sacrifice (1). Examples (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Meaning (1). Examples (1). Why fear grows (1). How belief helps (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Choose a goal (1). Learn from craft (1). Value of words (1). Courage and effort (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.